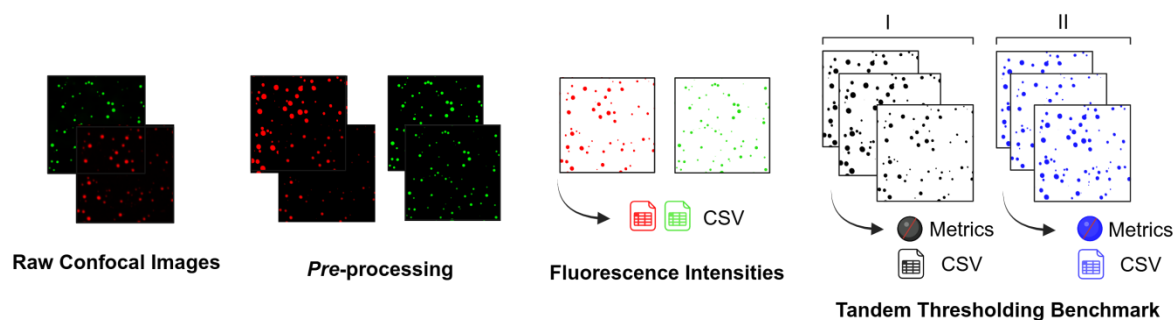


Automated Single-Channel Fluorescence Confocal Image Analysis Workflow for Fiji/ImageJ (1.54p)

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This project is an end-to-end, Python and Fiji pipeline for single-channel fluorescence microscopy (*.lsm*) images. It auto-normalises channels, tests multiple ImageJ threshold models ([doi.10.1117/1.1631315](https://doi.org/10.1117/1.1631315)), extracts morphology metrics (droplets number, area occupied, diameter), plots fluorescence intensity for both of the channels and summary visuals and exports everything to clean outputs with organised file housekeeping.

Who it's for?

Scientists and imaging specialists who need reproducible, high-throughput quantification of two-colour fluorescence data-especially in biomolecular condensate studies-and computational biologists who want ready-to-analyse tables and figures without babysitting ImageJ/Fiji.

Overview

This single-file Python workflow automates end-to-end analysis of two-channel Zeiss *.lsm* confocal images,

- 1. Fluorescence intensities.** The pipeline first determines the optimal min/max intensity range on the reference channel (C2 by default). Fluorescence intensity is then quantified by subtracting background, multiplying each grey-level value by its pixel count, and summing the results. The final value represents the total fluorescence from all signal-contributing objects visible in the image,
- 2. Thresholding benchmark.** The workflow supports evaluation of any number of Fiji's (19) built-in thresholding models (from just one to all), depending on user selection. Each model is applied to the intensity-adjusted C2 channel, which acts as the input mask. To separate merged droplets or overlapping regions, a watershed transform is automatically applied before thresholding.

For each model, the pipeline generates:

- the original input image
- binary masks resulting from each thresholding model,
- detailed measurement tables

Two parallel analyses are then performed for each model:

- one excluding objects on the edges of the image,
- one including objects on the edges of the image.

For each object, the following metrics are calculated:

- area
- perimeter
- two independent estimates of diameter (one from area, one from perimeter)
- object count

All measurements are saved as **CSV** files, separately for edge-included and edge-excluded analyses. Additionally, all per-model and per-metric statistics are merged and organised into structured **Excel** files.

Metric extraction. These statistical summaries include the median, first quartile (Q_1) and third quartile (Q_3) for every threshold model.

Model rankings. To identify the most reliable thresholding, the pipeline uses a Shewhart-style control chart approach:

- Each metric (Area, diameter, counts) it computes the median across all selected models for two parallel analyses,
- Then, the “best” threshold model for a given image is selected as the one whose metric medians are closest to the global average of all models. Additionally, Shewhart control ranges (± 1 SD, ± 2 SD, ± 3 SD) of the global median to help visualise and screen for models that deviate significantly from expected values.

All masks, overlays, and statistical summaries are saved, both individually and as part of a consolidated dataset. A final comparison plot summarises the thresholds’ performance side-by-side, enabling both automatic model selection and manual review.

Output

For every (*.lsm*) image the pipeline spins up a dedicated results folder whose name is a cleaned-up version of the original filename. At the top level you’ll find quick-look PNGs (C1 or C2, threshold grid, scatter plots) plus two workbooks that collect all object statistics, Shewhart scores and colocalisation metrics. Raw data are stored as CSVs.

<working-folder>/

└─ **Channel previews and histograms**

- | └─ <base>_C1 or C2_original.png # 8-bit, LUT-applied preview
- | └─ intensity_distribution_histograms.png
- | └─ fluorescence-intensities-C1 or C2.xlsx

└─ **Thresholding overview**

- | └─ grid_threshold_summary.png # one sheet with all masks side-by-side
- | └─ statistics.xlsx # per-model medians with Q₁ and Q₃
- | └─ statistics_edges.xlsx # the same, but “objects on edges” only
- | └─ statistics_plots.png # 3-panel plot: area, diameter, counts
- | └─ summary_threshold_results.xlsx # full per-object tables
- | └─ summary_threshold_edges_results.xlsx
- | └─ threshold_model_predictions.xlsx # ±1 SD / ±2 SD Shewhart ranking

└─ **edges analysis/** # Overlays for thresholding including the edges

- | └─ <base>_edges_<Model>.png (× N)

└─ **edges csv/** # CSV tables for the same edge objects

- | └─ edges_<Model>.csv (× N)

└─ **csvs/**

- | └─ results_<Model>.csv (× N)
- | └─ C1 or C2-intensity-histogram.csv

└─ **macros/** # All ImageJ/Fiji macros for full provenance

- | └─ macro_analysis.ijm

Installation

Setting up Fiji

1. **Install Fiji. Grab the latest bundled Fiji.app** (v. 1.54p at the time of publishing) from (<https://fiji.sc/>). Once installed, run the updater and add the PTBIOP plugin if you plan to run *JaCoP colocalisation* on your two-channel images,
2. **Configure Fiji for condensate analysis,**
 - Open original image. In *Set Measurements* tick the following: Area, Std Dev, Min & Max, Area Fraction and Perimeter,
 - In *Analyze* → *Particles* tick the following: Display Results, Clear Results, Summarize, Add to Manager and Overlay.

Setting up Python

1. **Install Anaconda / Miniconda.** Download the latest installer from and follow the on-screen instructions for your OS (<https://www.anaconda.com/>)
2. **Match the project's Python version (optional).** The scripts were developed under Python 3.11.9.
 - If you prefer to stay on the newest release (3.13 at the moment), the code runs fine—skip this step,
 - Otherwise, open an Anaconda terminal and create a 3.11 environment

```
conda install python=3.11.9
```

3. **Update conda in terminal,**

```
conda update conda
```

4. **Install required packages,**

```
conda install -c conda-forge opencv py-opencv pandas pillow matplotlib seaborn scipy openpyxl
```

5. **Edit python script in lines: 220, 1041 and 1042 with the direct path to Fiji.app,**

```
folder_path = "C:/.../fiji-win64/Fiji.app/ImageJ-win64.exe"
```

6. **Set your working directory.** Update the line 1041 to the directory that contains your .lsm images. Only files whose names start with exp are processed, so make sure your images follow that convention,

```
folder_path = 'C:/./...'
```

7. **Choose which threshold algorithms to benchmark.** On line 1042 edit the list called *threshold_models*. Provide any subset of Fiji's 19 built-in methods e.g. "Otsu", "Li", "Moments",
8. **Tidy filenames (optional).** If your raw image names carry distracting tags pH, salt, time points, etc. add those fragments to the *shorten_file_name* list on line 41. The helper function will strip them automatically so all outputs stay clean and readable.

How to run

Run the script from the terminal or Spyder program. All .lsm images in *folder_path* with names containing *exp* will be processed, and a results folder will be created for each image.

```
python github_machine_macro-single_biomolecular-condensates.py
```

Troubleshooting

On systems where Windows uses the *CP-1250* (Central European) code page, *UTF-8* decoding of Fiji's console output may fail on greek characters e.g. μ etc.

In that case, decode with *encoding="cp1250"* (you can run *chcp* to check the active code page 65001 = UTF-8, 1250 = CP-1250) and keep *errors="replace"* to prevent crashes.

Acknowledgments

This script and pipeline were designed and written by Michal Kacper Bialobrzewski (<https://github.com/bialobrezuski>). Please cite the following paper when using or adapting this code: <https://doi.org/10.64898/2026.07.16.738963>. I would like to acknowledge Zuzanna Staszałek, Barbara Klepka, Weronika Chmura, Zuzanna Hirszt and Marlena Stal for their valuable contribution in checking the workflow of the code.